

Information Cards — The Cormsil Compact

II-I22 · Print double-sided · Cut along borders · Hand player-facing front to agents on discovery

SUPPORTING INTEL

II

The Town of Cormsil

Cormsil is a farming town of approximately 400 people in the Yorkshire Dales. The earliest recorded settlement is Saxon, but the area shows evidence of pre-Saxon occupation — standing stones, burial mounds, and field patterns that predate the Norman church. The town's name may derive from Old English "Corm" (a personal name) + "syll" (a bog or marsh), though local tradition holds it's older — "the place where something sleeps." The pub is called The Dōmere Arms — no one knows why; it's always been called that. The town is insular, agricultural, and deeply resistant to outside attention.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1 (Cormsil Village), local interviews

HQ Fallback: Day 9

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Establishing context. The pub's name is a clue agents may notice — The Dōmere Arms. Asking about the name yields shrugs and "it's always been called that." A Lore roll (Diff 2) identifies "Dōmere" as Old English for "Doomer" or "Judge."

The Library Fire

Three weeks ago, on a Thursday evening, the Cormsil Public Library caught fire. The librarian, Eleanor Vane, had been working late cataloguing donations. She fell asleep at her desk; a scented candle ignited a stack of books. The fire spread rapidly through the dry paper and wooden shelving. Twenty-five people were inside — a reading group, a few students, some elderly residents attending a local history talk. All were initially reported dead. But witnesses saw them running from the building into the woods behind the library. They emerged the next morning, unharmed, claiming no memory of the night. The official fire report notes this as "unexplained survivor behavior" and closes with a recommendation for further investigation — which never came.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1 (town interviews), L2 (burned library), L4 (Eleanor Vane)

HQ Fallback: Day 9

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The key event. Agents should establish the timeline: fire at ~8 PM, 25 casualties, survivors emerged from woods at ~7 AM next day. The 9-hour gap is unexplained. No one in town has questioned it publicly — it's been called a miracle, and questioning miracles is poor form in a church town.

The Compact of 1882

Among the wreckage of the burned library, a shattered glass case is visible in the reading room rubble. Its brass label, still legible, reads: "Cormsil Compact, 1882 — On Permanent Loan from the Town Council." The case is empty. Ash fragments within suggest the document was inside when the fire reached it. No one in town can say what the compact was — most didn't know it existed. The older residents recall that there used to be an annual "reading day" at the church, discontinued around the time of the Great War, but no one remembers what was read or why.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1 (town), L2 (burned library), L3 (church — fire-damaged copy)

HQ Fallback: Day 8

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This is the first confirmation that a compact existed. The glass case label is unambiguous. Agents who ask about "reading day" get fragmentary memories: "my gran mentioned it," "the vicar used to read something from the pulpit every spring." The tradition ended around 1918 — 105 years ago.

Eleanor's Testimony

Eleanor Vane tells her story in a voice worn thin by sleeplessness. She fell asleep at her desk — she'd been working late, she was tired, the candle was scented with lavender, it was supposed to be calming. She woke to smoke. She tried to warn people. She saw them running — not toward the exits, but toward the back, toward the woods. She doesn't remember how she got out. She remembers the sound of the roof collapsing. Since the fire, every day, the 25 survivors visit her — one by one, sometimes in pairs now — to tell her they forgive her. "They don't want me to die," she says. "They want me to *know*. And I do. I know. I've known since the first one walked through my door. But knowing doesn't stop them coming." She has not slept in 19 days.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L4 (Eleanor's cottage), NPC1 (Eleanor Vane), O4M1 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 8

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This is the emotional core of the case. Eleanor's testimony confirms: (1) the fire was accidental, (2) the survivors ran into the woods, not away from the fire, (3) the visits are the returned's primary behavior pattern, (4) the "forgiveness" is not benevolent — it's a compulsion that functions as psychological torture.

The Fire-Damaged Copy

In the vestry of St. Cuthbert's Church, Reverend Threlfall produces a singed document — a partial copy of the Cormsil Compact, stored in the church since 1882. Fire damage from a vestry candle accident in the 1920s has destroyed about half the text, but legible sections describe: "the annual acknowledgment, to be read aloud at the stone on the first day of spring," and "the sleeping arrangement, whereby the buried one shall remain quiet so long as the compact is honored." The document is signed by "Arthur Hailes, Vicar" and a second name that is deliberately obscured — the ink has been scratched away. Below the signatures: "Witnessed by the Society, this 14th day of March, 1882."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (church vestry), NPC3 (Reverend Threlfall)

HQ Fallback: Day 7

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The fire-damaged copy establishes: (1) an annual acknowledgment ritual existed, (2) the compact was read "at the stone," (3) the spirit was referred to as "the buried one," (4) The Society witnessed the compact. The scratched-out second signature is a mystery — possibly the Society's representative, who preferred to remain unnamed.

Dwerryhouse's Notes

Tom Dwerryhouse has been keeping a notebook for three weeks. His observations of the returned — particularly his wife Mary, but also others he's encountered — are meticulous: "Blink rate: 3-4 seconds between blinks. Normal is 2-5 per second. Skin temperature: consistently cool, approx. 34°C regardless of ambient temperature. Speech patterns: tendency to finish sentences started by other returned — not interrupting, but overlapping seamlessly, as if they share a thought. Unison speech: observed twice — once at the pub, once at the church gate. Both times, they didn't seem to notice they were doing it. Eleanor Vane: visited daily by all 25. She hasn't slept. I've watched her window. The light is always on."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L1 (town), NPC2 (Tom Dwerryhouse), O2M1 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 7

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Dwerryhouse's notes are the agents' best local intelligence. They document the tells systematically. Tom is not a conspiracy theorist — he's a farmer who knows his wife and knows the woman in his house is not her. Sharing this with agents requires trust. If agents are dismissive, he withdraws and the notes become unavailable.

The Fire Investigator's Report

The official report from the North Yorkshire Fire Service confirms: the fire started from a scented candle on the librarian's desk, ignited a stack of donated books awaiting cataloguing, and spread through the building's dry timber construction. Cause: accidental. The report includes an unusual section titled "Survivor Behavior": "All 25 casualties were observed exiting the building through the rear fire door and proceeding into the woodland behind the library. This behavior is inconsistent with standard fire evacuation patterns, which would direct occupants toward the front entrance and the village green. When located the following morning at approximately 0700 hours, all 25 were at the treeline, disoriented, with no memory of the intervening 9 hours. Medical examination found no injuries. This investigator recommends further inquiry, which was not pursued due to resource constraints."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L2 (burned library — report filed at town council office)

HQ Fallback: Day 7

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The report is objective, secular confirmation that something anomalous happened. The investigator noted the behavior was wrong but had no framework for understanding it. The report can be obtained from the town council office — a simple request or low-Diff Manipulate (the clerk is bored and helpful).

The Returned Coordinate

Something has changed. The returned have begun visiting Eleanor in groups — two or three at a time, then five, then more. They speak in unison without appearing to notice. At the pub, three returned ordered the same drink at the same moment, in the same words, and didn't react when the barman pointed it out. The skeptical townsfolk are alarmed. Tom Dwerryhouse says: "They're getting organized. They don't know they are, but something's organizing them." The returned have started gathering at the burned library at dusk — standing in a loose group, facing the ruins, silent. They disperse after an hour without speaking to anyone.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: OlM1 trigger (Day 7)

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This marks the escalation from passive to coordinated. The returned are not consciously organizing — the Dömere is using them more actively. After this point, the returned are harder to interview individually — they're always in pairs or groups. The unison speech is the most visible tell.

The Society's Manual

Behind a loose stone in the crypt of St. Cuthbert's Church, agents find a small, leather-bound volume — a handwritten field guide, Victorian in origin, approximately 80 pages. The title page reads: "A Practical Guide to Negotiation with Subterranean Presences — For Field Use Only — The Society." The manual is unsettlingly knowledgeable. It describes entities "bound to specific geographies, predating human settlement, responsive to moral imbalance — specifically, death by neglect, violence, or preventable error." It outlines methods for acknowledgment rituals, negotiation frameworks, and binding ceremonies. A section titled "The Yorkshire Presence" matches the Dōmere exactly: "Called Dōmere by the Saxons — the Doomer. Cannot be slain. Responds to compact. Prefers acknowledgment to confrontation. Do not attempt exorcism — it predates the faith and does not recognize its authority." The manual references "Colne's manuscript (1642, British Library)" and "the standing stone at Cormsil — the original site, pre-Saxon."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (church crypt), NPC3 (Reverend Threlfall — shows agents the loose stone)

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel (Essential)

Notes: This is THE key document of the case. It provides: (1) the Dōmere's name and nature, (2) the negotiation framework, (3) references to Colne's manuscript and the standing stone, (4) the binding/silencing ritual outline, (5) confirmation that The Society existed and was knowledgeable. Finding the manual activates O3. The manual itself is not magical — it's a reference document. But what it references is real.

The Vicar's Summary

Among Vicar Arthur Hailes's papers at the Bodleian Library, a handwritten summary of the 1882 compact negotiations. Key points: "The entity accepted the terms after three nights of negotiation at the stone. It speaks in layers — Old English first, then something older. It understands language but not time. The compact requires annual acknowledgment of all wrongful deaths within its radius. This was read aloud at the stone each spring. The entity accepted and withdrew. I was told it would sleep so long as the reading continued. I have continued the reading for six years. The parish thinks it is a tradition. They do not know what it keeps asleep." The summary also notes: "The Society representative departed immediately after the compact was witnessed. I was given a volume for reference, which I was instructed to return. I have not returned it. I have hidden it in the church, for I believe the knowledge it contains is too dangerous to lose and too valuable to surrender."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L5 (Bodleian Library, Oxford)

HQ Fallback: Day 6

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The vicar's summary confirms: (1) the compact's terms, (2) the annual acknowledgment kept the spirit asleep, (3) The Society was involved, (4) the vicar deliberately hid the manual rather than returning it, (5) the spirit "understands language but not time" — it perceives events but not their sequence in human terms.

The Stone Is Warm

After collapsing into catatonia for several hours, Eleanor Vane wakes and begins writing. She fills pages with a single sentence, over and over, in handwriting that is recognizably hers but somehow wrong — too even, too steady for a woman who hasn't slept in weeks: "The stone is warm. The stone is warm. The stone is warm." When agents ask what she means, she looks at them with confusion and fear. "I don't know," she says. "I've never been to any stone. I don't know why I wrote that." She doesn't recognize the handwriting as her own. The Dōmere is speaking through her — using her as a conduit. The standing stone in Dwerryhouse's field has been growing warmer for three weeks. The spirit is rising.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L4 (Eleanor's cottage), NPC1 (Eleanor Vane), O4M2 trigger

HQ Fallback: Day 4

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This is the spirit's first direct communication through a non-retained human. Eleanor has no connection to the standing stone — she's never visited it, may not know it exists. The fact that she's writing about it means the Dōmere is breaching the boundary between itself and the living. This escalates the threat. The standing stone's location (L7) can now be triangulated: Dwerryhouse mentions a warm stone in his field.

The Vigil

Every evening now, the 25 returned gather at the burned library. They form a circle in the rubble, facing inward, standing perfectly still. They don't speak. They don't move. They just stand — for exactly one hour, from dusk to full dark — and then disperse, walking home separately, resuming their lives as if nothing happened. The town is terrified. The skeptical townsfolk watch from across the green. The believers stay indoors. Eleanor Vane has stopped leaving her house entirely — she knows they're out there, standing in the ash of her library, and she knows they're standing for her. The returned, when asked about the vigil, seem genuinely confused. "What vigil?" they ask. "We don't go to the library. It's burned." They have no memory of the gatherings.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O1M2 trigger (Day 4)

HQ Fallback: Day 4

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The vigil is the strongest evidence that the returned are not in control of their own actions. They have no memory of the gatherings — the Dòmere moves them while their conscious minds are elsewhere. This is deeply unsettling for agents to witness. +1 Corruption for observing a full vigil.

Colne's Manuscript — The Dōmere

Sir Geoffrey Colne's 1642 manuscript, "Of Certain Subterranean Presences in the County of York," identifies the entity beneath Cormsil. Key passages: "The presence is called Dōmere by the Saxons — the Doomer, the Judge. It predates the Celts, the Brigantes, and all known settlement. The Romans record an attempt to destroy it during the conquest of the Brigantes (circa 70 CE); the attempt failed. The presence cannot be killed — it is not alive in any sense we understand. It is a function of the earth, as gravity is a function of mass. It responds to wrongful death. It cannot abide an unbalanced moral ledger. The Saxons built a church above its resting place, believing confinement would weaken it. They were incorrect — the presence was merely... waiting." Colne describes his own failed attempt to exorcise it in 1642, noting: "I treated it as a demon. It is not a demon. It predates the faith and does not recognize its authority. It ignored my ritual entirely."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L6 (British Library, London)

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Colne's manuscript is the definitive identification of the Dōmere. It confirms: (1) the entity's name and nature, (2) it cannot be killed, (3) it responds to wrongful death, (4) Christian exorcism is ineffective, (5) it was "waiting" beneath the church. The manuscript provides CT-1 (full) and CT-2 (partial).

The Confrontation

The skeptical townsfolk, led by Tom Dwerryhouse, attempt to confront the returned during their evening vigil at the library. It goes badly. As the skeptics approach, shouting questions, demanding answers, the 25 returned turn as one — a single, synchronized movement. They speak in unison, a voice that is not quite 25 voices and not quite one: "We are the balance. Do not interfere." The skeptics fall silent. Several weep. The returned resume their vigil as if nothing happened. Afterward, the town is openly divided — believers versus skeptics, neighbors who won't make eye contact, families split down the middle. The returned continue their daily lives, unaware of what happened at the library. They don't remember the confrontation. They don't remember saying anything.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O2M2 trigger (Day 3)

HQ Fallback: Day 3

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: This is the first time the Dòmere speaks directly through multiple returned simultaneously. The voice is described as "layered" — listeners hear Old English, Brythonic, and something older, simultaneously, but understand the meaning regardless of what language they speak. The confrontation makes the town's division unbridgeable — agents can no longer maintain neutrality.

The Vicar's Letter

Vicar Arthur Hailes's sealed letter to the Bishop of Ripon, dated March 1883. The letter is cautious, uncomfortable, and carefully worded: "My Lord Bishop, I write concerning events in this parish which I cannot fully explain and which I am not certain I should attempt to. A compact has been reached between the town and a presence I am reluctant to name. The negotiations were mediated by persons who identified themselves only as The Society. I found them unorthodox but effective. They provided a volume of reference which I was instructed to return upon completion of the compact. I have not done so. I have hidden this volume in the church, for I believe the knowledge it contains is too dangerous to be lost to us and too valuable to be surrendered to those who would suppress it. The Society, I suspect, would understand. They have no name worth recording, for they prefer to remain unremembered. I ask your guidance, or your silence — whichever your conscience permits."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L5 (Bodleian Library, Oxford), after O3M1

HQ Fallback: Day 3

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The letter provides the fullest picture of The Society: (1) organized, secretive, effective, (2) the vicar trusted them enough to defy their instructions, (3) they "prefer to remain unremembered" — deliberate obscurity. The letter also confirms the manual was hidden intentionally, not lost. This closes the loop on how the manual ended up in the crypt.

Margaret Hale's Offer

One of the returned approaches the agents — not with the vague, slightly-off politeness of the others, but with clear intent. She introduces herself as Margaret Hale, a former schoolteacher. "I know what I am," she says. "I died in the fire. I remember the smoke, and the heat, and a window that wouldn't open. I remember running into the woods — not because I wanted to, but because something was pulling me. I woke up at the treeline and walked home. I've been... not myself... ever since." She has pieced together what the returned are, what the Dömere is, and what's being done through them. "I've been watching. Waiting. I knew someone would come eventually. Someone who could do something." She offers to help — whatever help means. She understands that helping may mean ending her borrowed existence. "I've already died once," she says. "At least this time, I'll know why."

DA REFERENCE

Sources: O1M3 trigger (Day 2), NPC5 (Margaret Hale)

HQ Fallback: None — Margaret must be encountered directly

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Margaret is the volunteer for the silencing ritual. She is the only returned who has achieved full self-awareness. She understands what she's offering. The agents must explain the ritual to her (she already suspects what it will require) and she must consent freely. If agents pressure or coerce her, the ritual fails — the volunteer component requires genuine willingness.

The Failed Binding of 1642

Sir Geoffrey Colne's manuscript describes his attempt to bind the Dömere in 1642. He approached it as a demon to be exorcised — Latin rites, holy water, the authority of the Church. The spirit ignored him entirely. "It did not resist," Colne writes. "It did not flee. It simply... failed to notice. It was as though I had attempted to command the tide to stop, or the wind to change direction. The presence is not hostile to our faith — it is indifferent. It was here before Bethlehem and will be here after Rome is dust." Colne learned from his failure. His manuscript becomes, in its later sections, a corrected field report: what the spirit actually responds to (acknowledgment, not command), what it wants (recognition of wrongs), and what might work instead of exorcism (negotiation, compact, binding through consent rather than force).

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L6 (British Library)

HQ Fallback: Day 5

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: Colne's failure is instructive. It teaches agents: (1) Christian ritual doesn't work on the Dömere, (2) the spirit responds to acknowledgment, not authority, (3) binding requires consent — the spirit must agree to terms. This is the theoretical foundation for both the silencing ritual and the negotiation path. Agents who skip Colne's manuscript miss this crucial lesson.

The Riddle

In the margins of Colne's manuscript, written in a careful 17th-century hand, is an Old English riddle:

*"I was here before the first king knelt.
I weigh what no scale can hold.
I sleep when remembered, wake when forgot.
The Saxons named me. Speak my name —
and I will answer."*

The answer is "Dōmere" — the Doomer, the Judge. The riddle encodes the spirit's true name without writing it plainly. Colne lived in an age of witch-hunters; he knew some knowledge was dangerous to record openly. The name, when spoken at the standing stone, forces the spirit to acknowledge the speaker. It is the first component of the silencing ritual.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L6 (British Library — Colne's manuscript margins)

HQ Fallback: Day 4

Type: Supporting Intel (Essential for CT-1)

Notes: The riddle requires Old English translation. If no agent reads Old English, the British Library manuscript librarian can arrange translation (+1 shift). Solving the riddle yields the true name: "Dōmere." The name must be spoken aloud at the standing stone for the silencing ritual. Without the name, the ritual cannot proceed. This is the gate for CT-1.

The Standing Stone

In a sheep field half a mile from Cormsil, a weathered standing stone rises from the earth — pre-Saxon, likely Brigantes. The farmer who owns the field, Tom Dwerryhouse, has noticed the stone is warm. It's never been warm before. The soil around it is darker than the surrounding earth. The grass within a 2-meter radius has died — not withered, but simply stopped growing, as if the ground has decided it will no longer support life. Birds avoid the radius. Sheep won't graze within 10 meters. The stone itself is granite, approximately 1.5 meters tall, with no visible markings — but touch confirms it: it's warm, roughly body temperature, and has been for three weeks. This is the Dömere's original resting place — where the Celts dug their ritual well, where the Saxons found it, where the church was built to contain it, where the compact was read aloud for 105 years.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L7 (Dwerryhouse's field), NPC2 (Tom Dwerryhouse)

HQ Fallback: Day 4

Type: Supporting Intel

Notes: The standing stone is the climax site. Dwerryhouse grants access if he trusts the agents (O2M1 or successful Manipulate). The warmth is a sign the Dömere is rising — the closer to the surface it gets, the warmer the stone becomes. After Day 4 (when the spirit speaks), the stone is visibly warm — steam rises from it on cold mornings.

The Well

Beneath the standing stone, capped with a Saxon stone slab and overgrown with centuries of soil and moss, is a well. Not a water well — a ritual shaft, dug by the Brigantes tribe when they first encountered the Dōmere. The well descends approximately 6 meters into the earth, ending at a natural fissure in the bedrock. The fissure is the Dōmere's access point to the surface — the place where it is closest to the world of the living. The Saxon slab is heavy but movable (Force Diff 2). Beneath it, the well shaft is dark and cold — but the soil at the bottom is warm. A handful of this soil, dug from beneath the stone, is the second component of the silencing ritual. The soil is darker than surface earth and slightly luminous in absolute darkness — a faint, cold phosphorescence, like the light of deep-sea creatures.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L7 (standing stone site — Investigate Diff 1 to locate the capped well)

HQ Fallback: Day 3

Type: Supporting Intel (Enables CT-3)

Notes: The well is the Dōmere's physical access point. The soil from beneath the stone is required for the silencing ritual. Extracting it requires moving the Saxon cap (Force Diff 2) and descending or reaching into the shaft. The soil is +1 Corruption to handle — it's saturated with the spirit's presence. Agents should collect it in a sealed container.

The Ritual Components

Cross-referencing the Society's manual with Colne's manuscript reveals the complete silencing ritual. Three components are required — missing any results in automatic failure:

1. The True Name: "Dōmere" — spoken aloud at the standing stone. The spirit must hear it. It will respond. This is the acknowledgment component — the name spoken by someone who understands what it means.

2. Soil from the Pre-Saxon Site: A handful of earth from beneath the standing stone, where the Brigantes dug their well. This soil is part of the Dōmere's original resting place — it carries the spirit's essence and serves as a material anchor for the binding.

3. A Returned Volunteer: One of the 25 must willingly participate, speaking words of release from the Society's manual. This ends their borrowed existence — the Dōmere's fragment withdraws from them. The volunteer must understand what they're choosing. Margaret Hale (NPC5) is the intended volunteer.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: L3 (Society's manual) + L6 (Colne's manuscript) — synthesis required

HQ Fallback: Day 2

Type: Supporting Intel (Enables Resolution)

Notes: This card is given to agents when they've assembled both key texts. The ritual must be performed at L7 (the standing stone). All three components must be present. The ritual takes approximately 30 minutes to perform. During this time, the Dōmere resists — +2 Corruption for all participants. The returned will converge on the site and must be held off non-violently.

What This Has Always Been About

The Dōmere is older than humanity. It was in the earth before the first Celts arrived, before the Brigantes dug their well, before the Saxons built their church, before the Normans raised St. Cuthbert's stone by stone. It is not a ghost. It is not a demon. It is not a god. It is a function — justice without mercy, consequence without choice, a ledger that must balance. It does not hate. It does not love. It responds to wrongful death the way water responds to gravity — inevitably, impersonally, and without end.

The compact of 1882 was the first time anyone treated it as a party to a negotiation rather than a monster to be slain. The Society understood what Colne learned: the Dōmere responds to acknowledgment. The annual reading kept it asleep for 105 years — not because the ritual had power, but because the acknowledgment satisfied its function. Someone remembered. Someone said the names of the wronged. That was enough.

The library fire destroyed the compact. The spirit woke in a world where a librarian fell asleep at her desk and 25 people burned. It found negligence. It found preventable death. It found no acknowledgment. It is furious — not with malice, but with the absolute fury of a law that has been broken and forgotten. It wants to expand because it sees a world full of preventable deaths and no one answering for them. It wants to fill the world with consequences.

The agents can silence it, or negotiate, or fail and watch it spread. The choice is theirs. But the Dōmere will not be the same as it was in 1882. It has been forgotten once. It will not trust again easily. Whatever terms it accepts will be harsher. Whatever binding is placed will be tested. The question is not whether the agents can defeat the Dōmere — they cannot. The question is whether they can convince something older than humanity that the world is still worth sparing.

DA REFERENCE

Sources: Synthesis of all three CTs and all essential intel

HQ Fallback: None — must be assembled by agents

Type: Containment Truth — Synthesis

Notes: This is the capstone card. It is given to agents when they have assembled the full picture — typically after obtaining the Society's manual (I9), Colne's manuscript (II3, II7, II8), and Margaret Hale's offer (II6). It represents the moment of understanding: the Dōmere is not evil, not hostile, not even conscious in human terms — it is a function of the universe that humanity stumbled into and must learn to coexist with. The card provides no new mechanical information but frames the final choice emotionally and thematically.